



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE  
HEADQUARTERS UNITED STATES AIR FORCE  
BOLLING AFB, D.C. 20332-6098

AF Blue Fly  
Dec 94

December 21, 1994

AFHSO/HOS  
170 Luke Ave Suite 400  
Bolling AFB DC 20332-5113

[REDACTED]  
[REDACTED]  
[REDACTED]

Dear Mr. [REDACTED]

This responds to your recent FOIA/Congressional request. After a thorough search of our historical materials, we are enclosing two of the three documents related to Operation Blue Fly/Project Moon Dust which could be found among those holdings. Both have recently been declassified as a result of another FOIA. The third is still under FOIA review, and further information will be provided once the process is completed.

Sincerely

[REDACTED]

Historian, Reference Branch  
AF History Support Office

Attachments

1. TWX, FTD/AFSC to AFMDC, TD-AWFA 2A 16-11-191, 16 Nov 62. This message is notification to proceed in setting up BLUE FLY.
2. Letter, FTD to AMD, et al "(U) Project BLUE FLY," 22 Oct 62.
3. Letter, AFSC to /to all divisions/centers/, subject: "AFSC Support to FTD for Activities Project," which is cited in letter mentioned above, dated 14 August 1961

The 14 Aug 61 letter is apparently the first notification to this Center that the project was pending. It has been in existence for many years as a concept. /A document on the concept will be forwarded by Lt. Thompson/

1-41

[REDACTED]

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INTERVIEW - MR. CORNETT with 2nd Lt. Joseph E. Thompson, AFMDC,  
Foreign Technology, 7 January 1963.

Project BLUE FLY - Project first originated in 1961 as part of the Foreign Technology Division project activities to "exploit" when possible enemy materials. There are actually three projects as follows:

- (1) BLUE FLY - Exploit Soviet hardware when it comes more or less permanently into US or allied hands.
- (2) ROUND ROBIN - Exploit Soviet hardware when it comes temporarily into US hand (e.g., Russian aircraft landing at international or US airfields).
- (3) MOON DUST - Exploit big booster or missile and satellite equipment which fall from the air hence the name applied (e.g., the piece of Soviet equipment which fell into Wisconsin).

During the Cuban crisis, two BLUE FLY teams came into existence at AFMDC. The first for immediate reaction is composed of military only. They have blanket orders prepared and will participate in any invasion or go to selected points to review equipment falling into US hands. The second team is military and civilian. It is largely a concept and this team will more than likely be used in so called cool spots. They will not follow an invasion team but will go to selected spots where security is assured. During the Cuban crisis, the number 1 team had an aircraft on standby alert, had equipment issued and were waiting for a message to move into action. By this date, the second team has been picked and is available on a 48-hour call. AFMDC's participation in the BLUE FLY operation is in part limited by its geographical location. Most AFSC Center/Divisions and the Foreign Technology Division have similar capabilities. In effect the three operations or projects mentioned above are actually compiled into one team.

FINANCING THE OPERATION - Supply items are procured through normal supply channels because of the so called special items or equipment needed (i.e., special cameras, recording equipment, etc) are difficult (but not impossible) to justify at AFMDC. In the Cuban crisis no effort was spared in supplying the BLUE FLY team with normal supply items (e.g., B-4 bags and 45 calibre automatics).

TDY funds for the operation are justified through normal Finance funds. The only problem is the difficulty in budgeting for an anticipated operation. This coming fiscal year will be the first attempt at financing and justifying a budget for anticipated use. \$4100 will be requested in travel funds. The big problem, as explained by Lt Thompson, is in the split responsibility: orders come from FTD but the money has to come from the Center. "We have just recently been able to explain this concept to Colonel Cleveland."

AFMDC 63-0421

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**HISTORY OF  
AIR TECHNICAL INTELLIGENCE CENTER**

**1 JULY 1954 - 31 DECEMBER 1954**



**AIR TECHNICAL INTELLIGENCE CENTER**

**WRIGHT-PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE  
OHIO**

**Copy No. 1**

**T55-211**

**EXCERPT  
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[REDACTED]

(Uncl) "Blue Fly":<sup>14</sup>

This project remained in a "stand-by" status during this reporting period and was not activated. (Uncl)

A problem arose as to the priority classification assigned to "Blue Fly" project by the 18th Air Force. The liaison officer, Major Harold M. Bergeson, and the AFIC Project Monitor met and resolved this and other problems of minor importance. As a further result of this conference,

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13. Project 40001, Collection of ATI Information - Specific Requests.
  14. Project 40020, Collection of ATI Information - Foreign Equipment and Materiel.
- [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]